

Yet, a well-passed-down and firmly believed Money Story is that budgets universally mean we're financially adulting.

Some Money Stories and money myths are cultural. These might include the idea that unless you have the right sort of education you won't be a financial success. The result of a money myth like this could be that someone with an entrepreneurial bent might enrol in a course they're not excited about in order to keep their parents happy or because they believe that certain professions automatically equate to financial success. This can certainly be the case for second generation Australians whose parents want their children to have the success they didn't have.

Take the example of Jane Lu, founder of Showpo. Jane studied and worked as an accountant but quit her job because she hated it. She hid from her parents the fact she'd quit and started Showpo because she knew they'd be worried and potentially disappointed in her. Fast-forward to today and the company turns over more than \$85 million per year—something that was worth Jane bucking her Money Story for.

This is a Money Story I grew up believing too. I studied law straight after high school, but, when I discovered that wasn't for me, I felt compelled to undergo further study because I didn't want to disappoint my dad. The Money Story I was told by him again and again growing up was that I was a 'smart girl'; therefore, I couldn't waste my talent on something that wasn't a 'real profession'. I ended up studying accounting because my dad was an accountant and suggested it—it was a move designed purely to keep him happy, not from any interest on my behalf. Thankfully I was able to take my love of writing and business to turn accounting into something that worked for me. I've finally stepped away from it and if I'm honest, part of the reason it took me so long was because that Money Story was so deeply embedded in me.

Other Money Stories have been unwittingly passed down by parents, peers, the media and society in general. In Australia, for example, we're often told that it makes the most financial sense to buy your own home, or that property always doubles in value every seven years.

Sure, the first statement might be right for some people but, like most things, it shouldn't be gospel for all. As for doubling in value, this is based on the generalisation that over the long term most capital city property increases in value at an average of seven per cent per year. This has led to